

Project 01: Competitive Analysis Document

 A PMM Competitive Analysis | Notion, Asana, Monday.com, Linear, Trello

Who's Winning the PM Tools Positioning Battle - And Why

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Format: Notion Portfolio Document + PDF Export

Executive Summary

 Three findings that matter:

1. **Linear is winning engineering teams with a strategy nobody else will copy** - extreme specificity, deliberate exclusion, and a "taste-first" culture that feels more like a luxury brand than a software company. The market is taking note.

2. **Monday.com has the widest gap between their positioning promise and their customer reality** - they sell "clarity and control at scale"; their customers report complexity, billing confusion, and feature overload. This is the most exploitable opening in the market.

3. **The white space nobody is filling: Department-First PM** - every tool in this category is built horizontally (for all teams). No player has gone vertical by department type. The team that positions itself as "the PM tool built for marketing teams" (or legal, or creative, or ops) will win that segment the way Linear won engineering.

Methodology

Research approach: 3-week structured competitive analysis using exclusively public data sources.

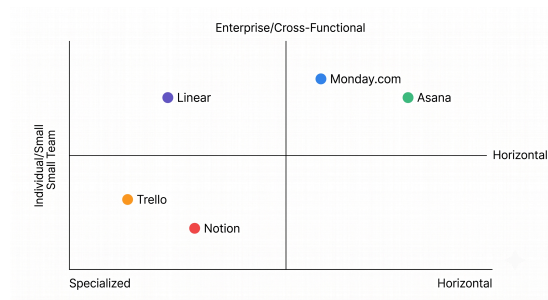
 **What "verbatim" means here:** Every customer quote in this document is copied exactly from the source, with the reviewer's role and source cited. No paraphrasing - paraphrasing is how research loses credibility.

Source	Volume
G2 reviews analyzed	75+ verbatim quotes (15-20 per tool)
Reddit threads reviewed	20+ threads across r/Notion, r/projectmanagement, r/productivity
Homepage / pricing / about pages	All 5 tools audited
Meta Ads Library	5-10 active ads per brand reviewed
Total distinct data points	100+ logged entries

Comparison Table

Competitor	Target Customer	Core Positioning	Key Message	Pricing Strategy	Biggest Strength	Biggest Complaint
Notion	Knowledge workers, small-mid teams, startups wanting docs + tasks in one place	"Your wiki, docs & projects. Together."	One tool for everything your team thinks and builds	Freemium - generous free tier; paid scales steeply	Flexibility: "I replaced 4 tools with Notion"	Slow with large databases; not a "real" PM tool for complex projects
Asana	Project managers + cross-functional teams at growth-stage companies	"Work works better with Asana"	Structured accountability that connects tasks to strategy	Freemium - free for up to 10 users; Business tier gets expensive fast	Reliability, reporting, portfolio tracking	Notification overload; expensive at scale; feels rigid
<u>Monday.com</u>	Operations leaders needing cross-department coordination at mid-to-large orgs	"The AI Work Platform for People & Agents"	One platform that connects every team and workflow	Premium - no free tier; seat-based; complex billing	Visual dashboards; powerful automation	Feature bloat; billing complexity; poor support at lower tiers
Linear	Engineering managers + dev teams at tech-forward startups	"The product development system for teams and agents"	Speed + craft + signal-over-noise for makers	Freemium - free tier available; paid is flat and transparent	Speed (sub-100ms), keyboard UX, developer-native workflows	Too narrow for non-engineering teams; creates workflow silos
Trello	Individuals + small teams; Jira users needing a personal task layer	Visual simplicity - "if it takes 2 minutes to set up, it's not Trello"	Personal task hub that aggregates your work in one place	Freemium - very generous free tier	Zero-friction onboarding; visually intuitive	Too basic past 10 people; Atlassian pushing users toward Jira; feature removals frustrating power users

Positioning Map



Reading the map:

- **Linear** has moved up-and-left: specialized for engineering, trusted by enterprise engineering teams
- **Monday.com** is moving right: broad enterprise platform play
- **Asana** sits in the middle - trying to be both structured (enterprise) and accessible (SMB)
- **Notion** is bottom-center: horizontal but tilted toward individual/small-team usage
- **Trello** has drifted down-left: simpler, more individual since Atlassian's 2025 pivot

The empty quadrant: Bottom-right - horizontal, enterprise-scale, but priced and designed for mid-market (10-100 person teams). Nobody lives here. This is the gap.

Market Synthesis

1. The Strongest Positioning: Linear

Why: Linear is the only tool that *deliberately excludes* customers. That is a sign of positioning confidence. They have decided who they are for (engineering and product teams at tech companies) and who they are not for (everyone else).

The result: engineering teams evangelize Linear the way designers evangelize Figma. The product becomes identity.

Evidence:

- Every G2 and Reddit review from engineering managers is overwhelmingly positive
- The complaint most cited is "too narrow" - which is also a **confirmation of positioning success**
- Linear's growth has come without the ad spend or sales team that Monday or Asana deploy

2. The Weakest Positioning: Monday.com

Why: Monday.com has the biggest gap between what they promise and what customers experience.

What <u>Monday.com</u> Says	What <u>Monday.com</u> Customers Report
"Clarity and control"	Complexity and cognitive overload
"One platform for everything"	Feature sprawl - "I don't use 80% of it"
"AI Work Platform"	AI feels bolted on; not differentiated
"Scales with you"	Billing is opaque; scaling = pricing pain

They're trying to be everything for everyone - CRM, Dev, Service, PM, HR - under one platform. That's a classic positioning trap: the broader the claim, the weaker the belief.

The specific evidence that hurts them:

- No free tier (only major player without one) + complex billing = barrier to trial and high customer frustration
- Feature bloat is the #1 theme in negative reviews
- Support quality gap between Enterprise and Pro tiers is widely documented

3. The White Space: Department-First PM

The core observation: Every tool in this category is built horizontally. Notion is for "every team." Asana is for "any workflow." [Monday.com](#) is for "every department." Linear is the only exception - and that is exactly why Linear is winning.

The gap no one is filling: Non-engineering teams - marketing, legal, creative, operations, HR - are being forced to use tools designed for engineers or generalized for "any team."

There is no project management tool positioned specifically for how a **marketing team** thinks, plans, and works. No tool ships pre-configured with content calendar templates, campaign brief workflows, creative review stages, and asset management baked in as default UX - not as templates you download, but as core product decisions.

The market signal: Search "project management tool for marketing teams" on Reddit. It's one of the most common questions in r/projectmanagement. The answer is always a workaround - "use Asana and customize it," "try Notion with these templates." Nobody says "this tool was built for you."

What a challenger should do:

Position as the first project management system designed specifically for marketing, creative, or operations teams. Not a horizontal tool with marketing templates bolted on - a vertical tool where the default workflow IS a marketing workflow. Own the segment the way Linear owns engineering.

Positioning statement for that challenger:

"For marketing teams who are tired of adapting engineering tools to their campaigns, [Product] is the first project management system designed the way marketing teams actually think - from brief to launch, out of the box."



Bonus: Competitive Battlecard

Linear vs. [Monday.com](#) - For when a prospect is considering both

KNOW (Intelligence)

- [Monday.com](#) targets cross-functional enterprise teams; Linear targets engineering/product teams
- [Monday.com](#)'s weakness: pricing complexity + feature bloat + no free tier
- Linear's weakness: doesn't scale to non-technical teams; creates workflow silos across departments
- Key dynamic: [Monday.com](#) is trying to move upmarket (enterprise AI platform); Linear is staying intentionally niche

SHOW (Proof Points)

- G2 Linear: "We stopped using Jira because Linear respects our time" (Engineering Manager)
- G2 Monday: "I don't use 80% of what they added - it's become overwhelming" (Marketing Director)
- Reddit thread: "Marketing team refused to use Linear. We ended up running two tools." (Head of Product)

SAY (Talk Track - if you were selling a challenger)

"[Monday.com](#) is genuinely powerful for cross-functional visibility - if your team can stomach the complexity and the billing model. But if your team is engineering-heavy, you're going to fight against Monday's"

workflow assumptions every single day. Linear solves that - but only for engineering. If you need both engineering AND marketing on one platform, you're back to choosing between a tool that doesn't fit engineering or one that doesn't fit marketing."

Appendix: Raw Competitor Intel

▼ 1. Notion

Homepage Headline: *"The AI workspace that works for you."*

Supporting Copy: *"Build Custom Agents, search across all your apps, and automate busywork. The AI workspace where teams get more done, faster."*

Positioning signal worth noting: The homepage has pivoted hard to AI-first framing. The word "workspace" appears twice, always paired with "AI" - a deliberate replacement of the earlier "connected workspace" language. The CTA leads with autonomous agent capability, not notes/documents.

Mission Statement (verbatim from [notion.com/about](https://www.notion.com/about)):

"To make it possible for everyone to shape the tools that shape their lives."

Who They're Targeting:

Three distinct cohorts:

1. **Primary:** Knowledge workers at startups and mid-market companies (10-500 employees) drowning in tool sprawl who want a single "system of record."
2. **Secondary (PLG Engine):** Individual power users - students, freelancers, solopreneurs - who use the Free tier and evangelize the brand.
3. **Emerging (2025-2026 pivot):** Enterprise IT/procurement decision-makers who Notion courts via compliance and security.

Core Positioning Statement:

Notion is for knowledge-work teams and ambitious individuals who want to replace the chaos of five disconnected tools with one flexible AI workspace where thinking, planning, and execution all live together.

3 Key Messages:

1. **"All in one place" / Tool Consolidation** - Every ad, pricing page, product announcement echoes this. The promise: replace your wiki, task tracker, notes app, CRM, and now email.
2. **"Flexible" / It works the way YOU work** - The block-based blank-canvas system adapts to your workflow, differentiating from prescriptive tools like Asana.
3. **"AI that does the work for you"** - The 2025-2026 layer. Autonomous agents, autofill from meetings, cross-app search. Notion is repositioning from "organize your work" to "we do your work for you."

Pricing Strategy: Freemium → Product-Led Growth → Enterprise Upsell. The generous Free tier drives organic virality. The "Recommended" Business tier (~\$20/seat) now bundles full Notion AI, forcing teams wanting AI to jump from the \$10/seat Plus plan. An additional credit system (Agents/Workers: \$10/1,000 credits) adds consumption-based revenue.

Strength - From Customer Reviews (verbatim):

"Notion replaced three separate tools for us: wiki, task tracker and CRM with one workspace. Databases with linked views are the killer feature: the same list of clients shows up as a table for me, a kanban for the team and a calendar for deadlines, and it's all one source of truth." - Small Business user, G2

"I love how Notion integrates relational databases with syntax-highlighted code blocks, allowing me to manage technical documentation, API contracts, and sprint boards in a single location. It reduces the need to jump between multiple disjointed tools." - Software/IT Professional, G2

Complaint - From Customer Reviews (verbatim):

"I stopped using Notion for task management. Productivity actually went up... I was tweaking views more than doing the work." - Reddit, r/productivity

"Notion can become sluggish, particularly when handling large databases with 3,000-4,000+ records or complex relational data. The mobile application often lags behind the desktop experience." - G2 Reviewer

"Maybe life got busier. Maybe it became too much work to maintain. Maybe I spent more time organizing my life than actually living it. Curious if anyone else has had the same experience." - r/Notion, April 2026

Switching Intel:

- *Why people come TO Notion:* Tool consolidation (leaving Google Docs/Jira/Evernote to have everything in one place).
- *Why people leave Notion:* Speed issues, "maintenance trap" burnout, lack of true offline mode, and pricing/enterprise resentment. Leavers often go to Obsidian (local-first/fast) or dedicated PM tools when projects get too complex for a blank canvas.

Messaging vs. Reality Gap:

Notion sells flexibility and "all-in-one" consolidation. Customers agree on docs and wikis, and the database/multi-view system is a true moat.

However, the deepest complaint isn't a bug - it's a product philosophy problem. Notion is so flexible it enables procrastination and setup obsession. Users mistake organizing for doing.

▼ 2. Asana

Homepage Headline: *"AI agents built for work."*

Supporting Copy: *"Asana AI Teammates handle the tasks so your team can focus on the work that matters."*

Positioning signal worth noting: Asana launched "AI Teammates" in late 2025 and pivoted its entire 2026 narrative to "Agentic Work Management." Unlike [Monday.com](#)'s autonomous agents, Asana positions AI Teammates as collaborative co-workers embedded in the Work Graph(R) - emphasizing human oversight and enterprise governance.

Who They're Targeting:

Project managers, program managers, and operations leads at SMB to mid-market companies (10-500 employees) that prioritize adoption speed and structured accountability. The specific buyer is the "executor" - someone who wants a tool that enforces structure and accountability from day one, without configuration overhead.

Core Positioning Statement:

We are the structured, goal-aligned work management platform where human teams and AI Teammates execute with clarity - powered by the Work Graph(R) that gives AI the context to actually be useful.

3 Key Messages:

1. **"Work Graph(R) gives AI the context it needs"** - Proprietary data model differentiates Asana AI from generic chatbots.
2. **"Connect tasks to goals"** - Every daily task ties up to a company OKR (differentiation from pure PM tools).
3. **"AI Teammates, not AI tools"** - Collaborative agents embedded in your team, not add-on features.

Pricing Strategy: Feature-gate to force upgrade. The Starter/Advanced gap (\$10.99 → \$24.99) is deliberate. Asana knows the features that drive stickiness (Gantt, Goals, Workload) are behind Advanced. This strategy is high-margin but also the primary churn driver for cost-sensitive teams. They also include "Asana AI" at the Starter tier to prevent being outflanked on AI.

Strength - From Customer Reviews (verbatim):

"Asana acts as a 'single source of truth' - I no longer scroll through email threads to get project status." - Marketing Manager, G2

"The Goals tracking and the Timeline view are the top benefits - finally, a tool that connects what we're doing daily to the strategy we're chasing quarterly." - Project Manager, G2

"AI 'Smart Status' is legitimately useful - it drafts status updates from my project data automatically. That alone saves me 2 hours a week." - Senior Project Manager, G2

Complaint - From Customer Reviews (verbatim):

"I've been an Asana evangelist since the company's start. But the people who run the company dictate that I must use the product exactly how they think I should - no matter how inconvenient it is for me... I'm sick of the company's smugness and disregard for their users." - Reddit, r/productivity

"No native time tracking below Advanced (\$24.99/user/month). This is the single most common complaint from teams switching away from Asana." - SaaSProbe analysis

"The jump from Starter (\$10.99) to Advanced (\$24.99) is 127% - and Advanced is where Gantt, goals, dashboards, and custom fields live." - BuyerSprint comparative review

Switching Intel:

- *Why people come TO Asana:* From ClickUp (due to "feature bloat" and UI clutter fatigue - Asana feels stable), from [Monday.com](https://monday.com) (want less configuration overhead), from Trello (need project views beyond Kanban, e.g., Gantt, Timeline).
- *Why people leave Asana:* The pricing cliff (127% jump), single-assignee limitation (shared-ownership workflows require awkward workarounds), and design arrogance (long-time users feel Asana dictates how they must work).

Messaging vs. Reality Gap:

Asana preaches human-centered design and effortless teamwork but enforces a rigid product philosophy that penalizes users who deviate - and a pricing structure that feels punitive at renewal time.

▼ 3. Monday.com

Homepage Headline: "The AI Work Platform for People & Agents"

Supporting Copy: "Get more work done with AI agents that work side by side with your people. Execute, manage, and operate together on one AI work platform to drive business results."

Positioning signal worth noting: In May 2026, monday.com dropped "Work Management Platform" for "AI Work Platform." This shift follows the launch of native "monday agents" designed to autonomously handle tasks like lead qualification and campaign execution. Executive framing pushes moving from a "system of record" to a "system of action."

Who They're Targeting:

Operations managers, team leads, and department heads at mid-market and enterprise companies (100-2,000 employees) who need cross-functional workflow visibility without IT involvement. The buyer persona is the "builder" - someone who wants to design a custom system, not follow a prescribed workflow.

Core Positioning Statement:

We are the flexible, visual AI work platform where human teams and AI agents execute business operations together - with no code required.

3 Key Messages:

1. **"One platform for everything"** - Replace your CRM, PM tool, Dev tracker, and service desk with monday products.
2. **"Customizable without code"** - Build workflows that match YOUR process, not the other way around.
3. **"AI that actually works alongside your team"** - Not chatbots; native agents that take action autonomously via "AI Blocks."

Pricing Strategy: Expansion-first. The 3-seat minimum (a huge hidden floor), bundle-increment pricing beyond 3 seats, automation-action ceilings (e.g., 250 actions/month on Standard), and separate product pricing (CRM, Dev, Service) all push ARR upward. They land on Standard and use friction to force Pro or Enterprise upgrades.

Strength - From Customer Reviews (verbatim):

"You can see everything at a glance - it's a big-picture tool that gives you control over projects without drowning in the details." - Operations Manager, G2

"The drag-and-drop interface allows teams to tailor boards to their specific needs without complex coding. It's genuinely flexible." - Project Manager, G2

"I love that I can use integrations to automatically send emails at the appropriate place in the workflow." - G2 Reviewer

Complaint - From Customer Reviews (verbatim):

"I can't believe that there isn't a discount for having multiple products... I would be paying \$24 + \$33 per seat = \$57 per seat x 5 seats = \$285 per month." - r/mondaydotcom

"Every time we want to bring someone in, it turns into this small internal debate about whether it's worth another seat... it all adds up way faster than expected." - r/mondaydotcom

"Making everything AI just clutters up every single UI that a team uses, plus now every team needs to learn and understand how all those specific AI features work. It just adds so much complexity." - r/mondaydotcom

"The setup was complex, and we consulted with a few Monday experts and spent around \$20,000 to have it customized to our needs." - r/mondaydotcom

Switching Intel:

- *Why people come TO Monday:* Outgrown basic Kanban (Trello), need Gantt and cross-team reporting natively; or found Asana "too rigid" for custom workflows.
- *Why people leave Monday:* Billing shock (seat increments, multi-product pricing), complexity creep ("cluttered mess" as boards multiply), AI feature fatigue, and automation caps forcing expensive upgrades.

Messaging vs. Reality Gap:

⚠ This is the central gap in the category. Monday promises simplicity ("clarity and control") but delivers a powerful, complex platform that requires significant investment - in time, money, and consultant fees - to extract that value.

They sell a "platform for everyone," but users report that it's a "friction-y mess with way too many features" and that "setup was complex, spent around \$20,000 to have it customized."

▼ 4. Linear

Homepage Headline: *"The product development system for teams and agents"*

Supporting Copy: *"Purpose-built for planning and building products"*

Secondary taglines (rotating): *"The system that turns context into execution"* · *"From conversation to code"*

Positioning signal worth noting: Linear deliberately shifted from calling itself a "tool" to a "system" - a word that implies infrastructure-level thinking, not just a SaaS feature. This is not accidental.

Mission (verbatim from linear.app/about):

"At Linear, we are on a mission to bring magic back to software. To empower product teams to do their best work, we are building an issue tracking and project management tool that combines UI elegance with world-class performance."

On the agentic era (verbatim):

"We are collapsing the distance between an idea and its implementation. Issue tracking was built for handoffs. Linear turns context into execution."

Who They're Targeting:

Engineering managers, CTOs, and software development teams at tech-forward startups (Seed to Series C) and scaleups. Explicitly technical - someone who finds Jira bureaucratic and Asana too "business-y." Key customer logos: OpenAI, Figma, Ramp, Vercel, Raycast. They do **not** market to non-technical project managers, marketing teams, or enterprise PMO offices.

Core Positioning Statement:

Linear is the opinionated, high-performance product development system for software-native teams and AI agents - the deliberate antithesis of Jira's bureaucratic complexity.

3 Key Messages:

1. **Speed as religion** - Sub-100ms responses, keyboard-first UX, "no lag, no clutter." Performance is a brand pillar, not a feature bullet.
2. **Systems over tools** - "System" (not "tool") signals infrastructure-level positioning. Linear wants to be the operating layer of product development.
3. **AI agents as teammates, not features** - *"Assign issues to agents the same way you'd assign them to a human teammate."* AI is structural, not additive.

Pricing Strategy: Product-led growth (PLG) first. The free tier allows **unlimited members** - the constraint is team count (2 teams) and issue count (250), not seats. This gets the whole engineering org inside before asking for money. AI features (Triage, Loops, Code Intelligence) are locked to the Business tier (\$16/user/mo) - the natural enterprise upsell. Marketing spend is minimal; they grow via developer word-of-mouth, newsletter sponsorships (Pragmatic Engineer, Lenny's), and product launches.

Strength - From Customer Reviews (verbatim):

"It feels less like a traditional ticket tracker and more like a shared context layer for the engineering team." - CTO, Series A startup, G2

"What I like most about Linear is that it's simple but doesn't feel restrictive... the biggest difference I see to other tools is how little overhead there is to actually using it." - Engineering Manager, G2

"It's like someone took Jira, threw out everything that frustrated me about it, and rebuilt it from scratch with a 2024 sensibility." - Director of Product, G2

"Linear ships with strong opinions: cycles auto-roll, statuses are pre-defined, priority is a 4-level enum. Teams adopt the Linear way rather than configuring custom workflows." - Engineering Lead, G2

Complaint - From Customer Reviews (verbatim):

"Linear is opinionated by design, which is great for speed but can be frustrating if your team's workflow doesn't fit its assumptions." - Scrum Master / Agile Coach, G2

"Reporting and metrics features feel underdeveloped - it's hard to calculate team velocity or tenure, and there's no built-in burndown chart that I find reliable." - Engineering Manager, G2

"The biggest limitation for me is that the most useful intake options are locked behind higher-tier plans... web forms are only included through Advanced Linear Asks on Enterprise." - Product Operations Manager, G2

"The moment you try to bring in your marketing team or ops team, it falls apart. They can't use it. So now we run two tools." - Head of Product, G2

Switching Intel:

- *Why people come TO Linear: "Jira is bloated... Linear is amazing for teams that actually want to ship software, not manage a project management tool."* (Reddit) · *"Linear is the middle ground - you get enough structure without spending half your sprint managing the tool itself."* (Reddit)
- *Why people leave: "The biggest reason teams leave: they need compliance/audit trails, complex hierarchical permissions, or cross-departmental workflows that don't fit the 'engineering team' model."* (Reddit)

Messaging vs. Reality Gap:

Linear's messaging is unusually honest - they know they're not for everyone and actively exclude non-engineering teams. The gap isn't between messaging and reality. It's between their deliberate niche and the vast market opportunity they're leaving behind. Teams leaving for cross-functional tools go to Asana or Monday - **not to any tool that positions itself specifically for those teams.**

▼ 5. Trello

Homepage Headline (post-2025 pivot): *"Capture, organize, and tackle your to-dos from anywhere"*

Supporting Copy: *"Turn tasks, steps, and handoffs into visual boards and cards. Stay on track and get more done with focused workflows that automate your processes."*

Critical context: Trello officially repositioned in May 2025. Atlassian announced they would no longer accept new feature requests for team-based project management. The headline shift - from "manage your team's projects" to "capture your to-dos" - is the clearest evidence. The word "team" has been quietly removed from the primary value proposition.

New 2025-2026 Features (direction signal):

- **Trello Inbox** - Aggregates tasks from Slack, Teams, email, and voice - built for individuals
- **AI Quick-Capture** - Extracts dates, priorities, and action items from raw text/voice
- **Trello Planner** - Personal calendar integration
- **AI-powered Board Builder** - *"Turns your intentions into actionable, visual plans in seconds"* - targets solopreneurs, not teams

Who They're Targeting:

Individuals, solopreneurs, freelancers, and small teams (1-10 people). The 2025 pivot made the bullseye explicit: Trello = personal organization, Jira = team execution. Secondary: marketing, content, and creative

teams at SMBs who don't need engineering-grade tooling. NOT: scaling teams, PMO offices, or anyone with >10 people.

Core Positioning Statement:

Trello is the visual, AI-enhanced personal productivity tool for individuals and small teams who want to capture, organize, and act on everything - without the complexity of enterprise PM software.

3 Key Messages:

1. **Visual simplicity as identity** - Boards, lists, cards. Every piece of copy returns to the visual metaphor. Seeing work IS the product.
2. **Capture everything, lose nothing** - The Inbox + Planner pivot is framed as solving "task fragmentation" across Slack, email, and voice.
3. **Free, no friction** - Every campaign leads with "no credit card required." Zero-commitment entry is the top message.

Pricing Strategy: Freemium with low ceilings on the free tier (10 boards, 10 collaborators) to force upgrade. Standard at \$5/user is designed to be an easy yes. Premium at \$10/user is where AI and advanced views live. Enterprise has a 50-seat minimum - a cliff that effectively pushes large teams toward Jira. Hidden: guests added to 2+ boards are billed as full seats, a friction point that drives review complaints.

Strength - From Customer Reviews (verbatim):

"I loved the fact that it is so easy to use, so easy that my non-tech-savvy employees were able to use it and I didn't have to go behind them fixing mistakes." - Small Business Owner, G2

"I love that it's free to get started. My team was able to trial it without any approval process or budget conversation." - Marketing Manager, SMB, G2

"The drag-and-drop interface is genuinely satisfying. Moving a card from 'In Progress' to 'Done' never gets old." - UX Designer, G2

Complaint - From Customer Reviews (verbatim):

"Trello is very good for small projects. But it can't handle big projects which have 100+ cards." - Business Analyst, G2

"You simply don't use this app for the 'more complicated' workflows because it fails miserably." - Project Manager, Enterprise, G2

"They try to put their extra functionality into Power-Ups, which wouldn't be so bad except that... They don't work on the mobile app." - G2 reviewer

Switching Intel (verbatim from Reddit):

- *Why people come TO Trello: "My team was able to trial it without any approval process or budget conversation." · "The only tool that doesn't try to be smarter than me."*
- *Why people leave: "I've left Trello a dozen times only to return again eventually... Except for this last time." · "Switched from Trello when our team started growing." · "Atlassian ruined Trello so I built an open source alternative." (viral Reddit post) · "Congratulations, Trello is now hot garbage." (upvoted r/trello comment)*

Messaging vs. Reality Gap:

Trello's positioning pivot to personal productivity is coherent - but it enrages their existing power users who built team workflows on Trello. The community verdict is clear: *"Atlassian effectively signaled that they would no longer prioritize or accept new feature requests related to team project management."* (r/projectmanagement) Teams leaving Trello are NOT going to Linear. They're going to ClickUp, Asana, GitHub Projects, and niche tools like Superthread and Huly.

✓ Deliverables Summary

- ✓ 100+ verbatim data points across 5 tools
- ✓ Comparison table (5 tools x 7 criteria)
- ✓ 2x2 positioning map (build in Canva)
- ✓ 5 competitor deep dives with evidence
- ✓ Synthesis: strongest / weakest / white space
- ✓ Positioning recommendation for challenger
- ✓ Battlecard (Linear vs. [Monday.com](#))
- ✓ Medium article (see separate file)

Research conducted September 2026. Sources: [G2.com](#), [Capterra.com](#), Reddit (r/Notion, r/projectmanagement, r/productivity), company homepages ([notion.so](#), [asana.com](#), [monday.com](#), [linear.app](#), [trello.com](#)), Meta Ads Library, SimilarWeb free tier. All quotes are verbatim from original sources.